



LUXURY RESALE INTELLIGENCE

A marketing analysis of The RealReal

PORTFOLIO CASE STUDY • MARKET STRATEGY → QUANTITATIVE ANALYSIS

Executive snapshot

The RealReal is not simply selling secondhand luxury. It operates a two-sided marketplace built around reducing friction and uncertainty for both buyers and consignors.

44M+

MEMBERS IN THE
MARKETPLACE

50M+

ITEMS SOLD / TRANSACTION
HISTORY

2 SIDES

BUYERS + CONSIGNORS

TRUST

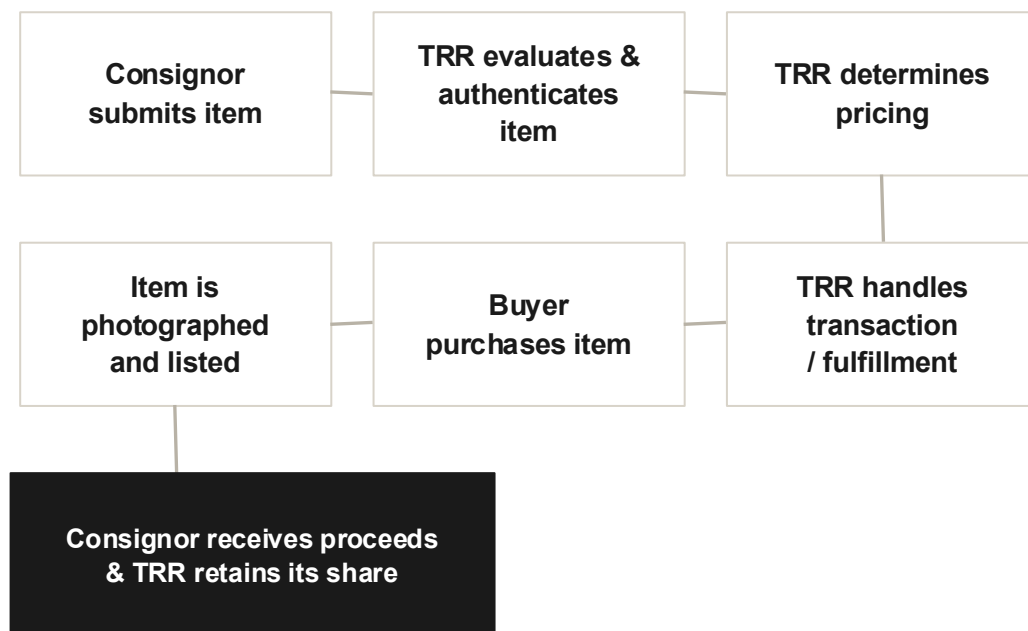
CORE MARKETPLACE
CURRENCY

CORE PROPOSITION

Authenticated luxury + data-driven pricing + discovery + convenience + marketplace reach

Sources: The RealReal 2026 Resale Report; 2025 Form 10-K; investor overview.

How the consignment model works



What TRR monetizes

TRR generally acts as an agent in core consignment transactions, retaining its share of the sale rather than recognizing the full selling price.

What the consignor buys

A managed resale service: authentication, pricing, photography, listing, customer service, storage and fulfillment.

Why the model matters

Supply is not manufactured by TRR. The marketplace must continually attract desirable inventory while maintaining buyer demand.

Source: Marketing analysis draft, Company & Market Overview.

Luxury resale changes the rules of retail

TRADITIONAL LUXURY RETAIL	LUXURY RESALE / THE REALREAL
PRIMARYLY NEW PRODUCTS	PRIMARYLY PRE-OWNED PRODUCTS
INVENTORY SUPPLIED BY THE LUXURY BRAND	INVENTORY LARGELY SUPPLIED BY CONSIGNERS
BRAND ESTABLISHES RETAIL PRICE	PRICES RESPOND TO SECONDARY MARKET FACTORS
CURRENT COLLECTIONS DOMINATE	CURRENT, DISCONTINUED, RARE, & VINTAGE COEXIST
BRAND PROVIDES AUTHENTICITY	RESALE PLATFORM MUST ESTABLISH AUTHORITY
SUPPLY DETERMINED BY PRODUCTION	SUPPLY DEPENDS ON WHAT ENTERS RESALE MARKET
CONSUMER PURCHASES FROM BRAND	PLATFORM CONNECTS CONSIGNORS AND BUYERS
LINEAR CONSUMPTION	MORE CIRCULAR BUY – OWN – RESELL CYCLE

Implication: TRR competes on market intelligence and trust—not product design or manufacturing.

Four forces are reshaping luxury resale

MAINSTREAM

93%

of Americans shop
secondhand online*

Resale is becoming a normal shopping channel rather than a niche alternative.

VINTAGE

+432%

growth in vintage demand,
2020–2026

Archive access and individuality expand the value proposition beyond discount.

CONDITION

+32%

sales growth for “Fair
Condition” items

Wear and age do not automatically eliminate desirability in resale.

GENERATIONAL

>50%

of TRR customers are Gen
Z + Millennials

Younger consumers are increasingly central to the marketplace.

Sources: The RealReal 2025 & 2026 Resale Reports. *Statistic cited by TRR from external research.

Resale is becoming a searchable fashion archive

Consumers increasingly search by designer era—not just by brand.

+650% *“Phoebe Philo Celine”*

+400% *“Nicolas Ghesquière Balenciaga”*

+375% *“Marc Jacobs Louis Vuitton”*

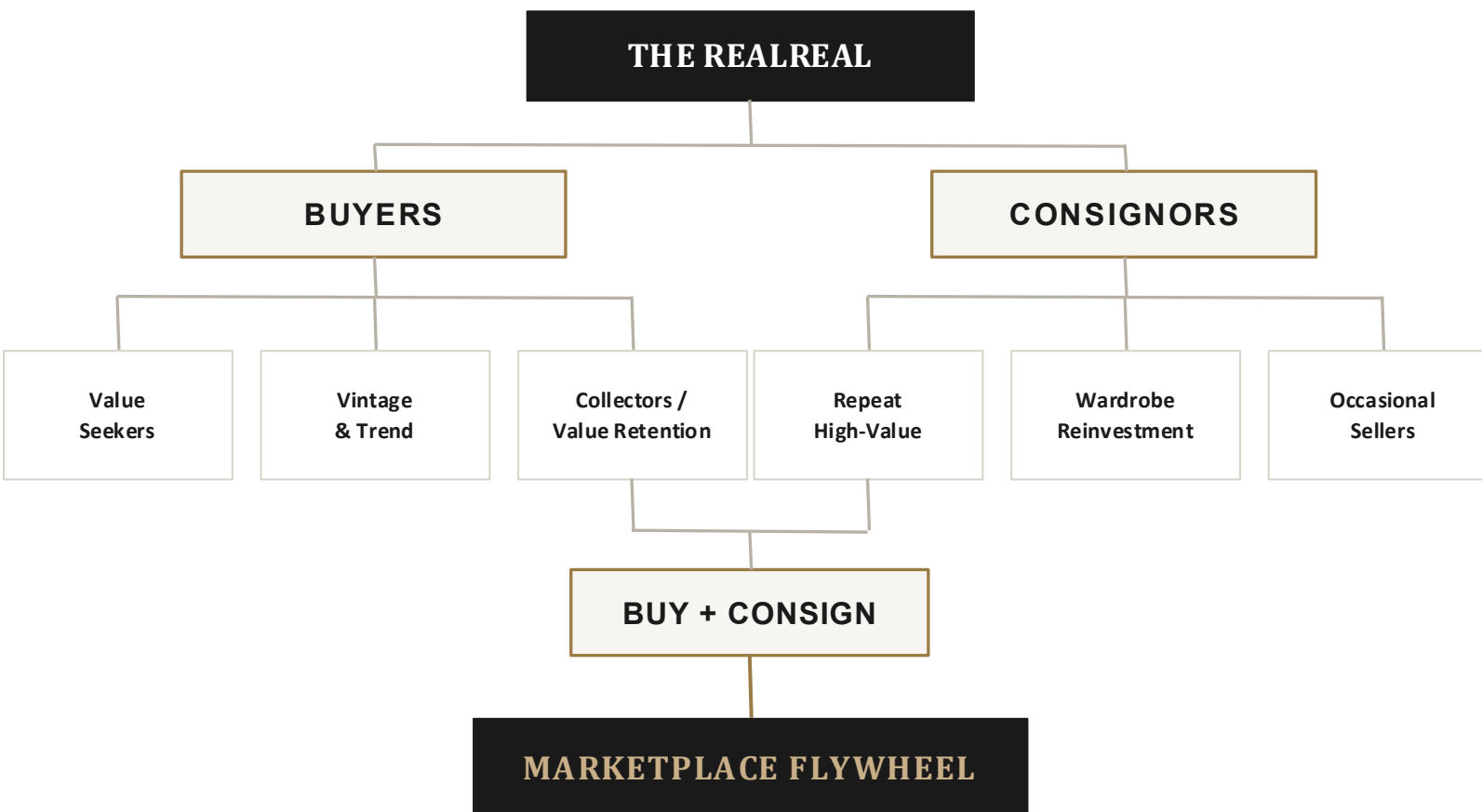
Marketing opportunity: position TRR around discovery and fashion history, not only “luxury for less.”

**A current boutique
sells the present.**

**A resale marketplace
can sell the present, the
discontinued, the rare—
and the archive.**

Source: The RealReal 2026 Resale Report.

The target market is an ecosystem



Buyer motivations

Value • vintage & trend • collecting / value retention • circular fashion

Consignor motivations

Repeat high-value selling • wardrobe reinvestment • convenient closet clean-out

Most valuable behavior

Customers who buy + consign contribute demand today and future supply tomorrow.

Source: Marketing analysis draft; TRR 2025 Form 10-K. Analytical segments are project hypotheses, not official TRR customer labels.

Competition spans two very different resale models

PLATFORM	LUXURY FOCUS	SELLER EFFORT	PRICING CONTROL	AUTHENTICATION	SELLER MODEL
The RealReal	High	Low	Platform	Central	Consignment / full service
Vestiaire	High	High	Seller	Strong	Marketplace
Fashionphile	Very high	Low	Platform	Central	Upfront offer
Rebag	Very high	Low	Platform	Central	Offers + resale
eBay	Low–Med	High	Seller	Eligible items	Marketplace
Poshmark	Low–Med	High	Seller	Eligible luxury	Marketplace

Sources: competitor pages cited in the marketing analysis draft. Classifications are analytical comparisons, not company ratings.

The RealReal occupies a distinctive middle ground



TRR combines luxury specialization with a low-effort, full-service seller experience—while maintaining broader assortment than accessory-focused specialists.

The marketing mix is built around the marketplace experience

PRODUCT

Luxury item + authentication + curation + discovery + convenience + trust

TRR adds services and confidence around products it did not manufacture.

PRICE

Dynamic, data-informed resale pricing

Pricing balances buyer value, consignor return and speed-to-sale.

PLACE

Digital marketplace + physical retail + consignment touchpoints

Stores serve both shopping and inventory acquisition.

PROMOTION

Demand generation + supply acquisition

TRR must market buying and consigning at the same time.

Pricing is where marketing and data science meet

170+

attributes evaluated when pricing an item

TRR combines historical + real-time data, proprietary models and human expertise, with pricing designed around marketplace demand and speed-to-sale.

Brand	Condition
Material	Collection year
Demand	Availability
Search behavior	Comparable items

Portfolio bridge → What observable product attributes explain resale price?

Source: The RealReal Pricing; 2025 Form 10-K.

The value proposition reduces uncertainty on both sides

BUYER

“Can I trust this \$3,000 bag?”

- Authentication
- Condition transparency
- Cross-brand discovery
- Secondary-market value
- Established fulfillment & service

CONSIGNOR

“Will my item be valued and sold well?”

- Pricing expertise
- Marketplace reach
- Authentication credibility
- Low-effort selling
- Transaction + fulfillment support

TRR's brand promise: make luxury resale feel trustworthy, convenient and consistent with luxury expectations.

Trust is not just messaging— it is marketplace infrastructure

TRUST

reduces information asymmetry

Without buyer trust, demand weakens. Without consignor trust, desirable supply can move elsewhere.

AUTHENTICATE	Is it real?
VALUE	What is it worth?
REPRESENT	Is condition accurate?
FULFILL	Will the transaction work?

Strategic insight: TRR monetizes reduced uncertainty.

Source: The RealReal 2025 Form 10-K; marketing analysis draft.

SWOT: strengths and risks are tightly linked

STRENGTHS

- Authenticated luxury expertise
- Full-service consignment
- 50M+ item sales / proprietary data
- Broad, one-of-a-kind assortment

WEAKNESSES

- Dependent on consignor supply
- Less seller control
- Labor-intensive operations
- Reputation highly dependent on trust

OPPORTUNITIES

- Resale normalization
- Gen Z + Millennial participation
- Vintage / archive demand
- AI, personalization + buyer→consignor conversion

THREATS

- Counterfeit / authentication failures
- Specialist + peer-to-peer competition
- Economic sensitivity
- Competition for high-quality supply

Three opportunities rise above the rest

01

Turn data into value

Make resale intelligence more visible: historical ranges, value retention and demand signals where data quality supports it.

02

Own fashion discovery

Lean into archive, designer-era and vintage discovery—not simply discounted luxury.

03

Grow the flywheel

Use demand signals and personalized outreach to acquire desirable supply and convert more buyers into consignors.

Each recommendation can be tested or informed by quantitative analysis.

The marketing analysis leads to a measurable question

WHAT DETERMINES THE RESALE VALUE OF LUXURY FASHION?

PRIMARY MODELING QUESTION

To what extent can brand, category, condition, material, age and other observable characteristics predict resale price?

DESCRIPTIVE

SQL

What does the marketplace look like?

DIAGNOSTIC

SQL + stats

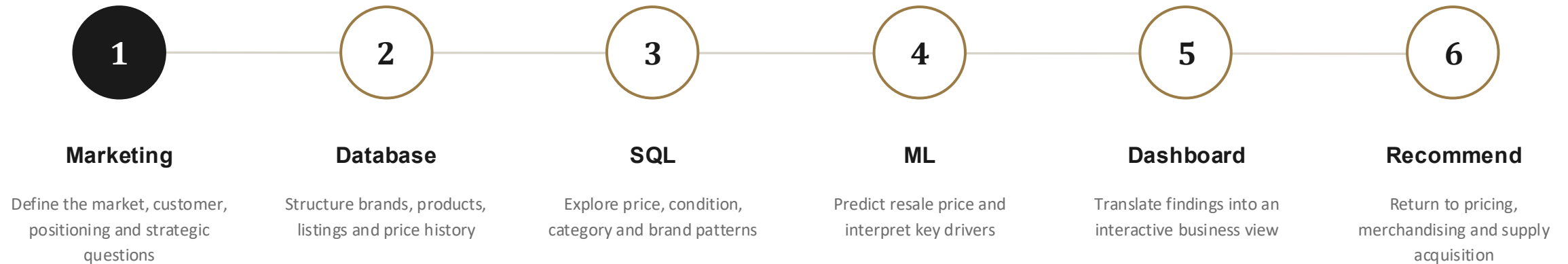
Why do prices differ?

PREDICTIVE

Machine learning

Can observable attributes predict resale price?

Portfolio roadmap



The marketing analysis is the hypothesis-building stage—not the endpoint.

Selected sources

THE REALREAL

- The RealReal — About Us
- The RealReal — Authentication
- The RealReal — Pricing
- The RealReal — Consignor Terms
- The RealReal — 2025 Resale Report
- The RealReal — 2026 Resale Report
- The RealReal, Inc. — 2025 Form 10-K
- The RealReal — Investor Overview

COMPETITORS

- Vestiaire Collective — About / Authentication
- Fashionphile — Sell With Us / Authenticity
- Rebag — Sell Now / Offer Values / Authenticity
- eBay — Authenticity Guarantee: Handbags
- Poshmark — Posh Authenticate

Full URLs and retrieval dates are preserved in the original marketing analysis document.